

Portfolio Complete Beginner's Manual

Publishing, Media, Projects, and Git Basics

Sagar Gharti Portfolio System

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Table of Contents

1. Quick Start Guide
2. Understanding File Structure
3. Adding Media to Projects
4. Git Commands You'll Use
5. Publishing Your Changes
6. Troubleshooting
7. Cheat Sheet

1. Quick Start Guide

Publishing Your Portfolio for the First Time

Your portfolio is already live! If you want to take it down and publish again (or update it), follow these steps.

Step 1: Install Git

Windows: Download from git-scm.com, run installer, use Git Bash

Mac: Open Terminal, type `git --version`, macOS will install it for you

Step 2: Configure Git (first time only)

```
git config --global user.email "ghartis@my.erau.edu"
git config --global user.name "Sagar Gharti"
```

Step 3: The Git Workflow (use every time you make changes)

```
git add -A
git commit -m "What you changed"
git push
```

What these commands do:

- `git add -A` = Prepare all your changes to be uploaded
- `git commit -m "msg"` = Take a snapshot with a description
- `git push` = Upload to GitHub (your website updates automatically)

2. Understanding File Structure

Here's what each folder does:

```
portfolio_new/
  ■■■ index.html          ← Main page (don't edit)
  ■■■ data/
  ■   ■■■ site.json      ← YOUR DATA (edit this!)
  ■■■ assets/
  ■   ■■■ images/
  ■     ■■■ profile.jpg  ← Your headshot
  ■     ■■■ projects/   ← Project images & videos
  ■     ■■■ cv/
  ■       ■■■ CV.pdf     ← Your resume
  ■■■ posts/
  ■   ■■■ posts.json     ← List of blog posts
  ■   ■■■ 2026-05-01-my-post.md
  ■■■ styles.css, script.js ← Design & behavior
```

Golden Rule: You only edit these files:

- ✓ • data/site.json for projects, skills, experience
- ✓ • posts/ folder for blog posts
- ✓ • assets/ folder for images, videos, PDFs

Never edit HTML, CSS, or JavaScript files unless you know what you're doing.

3. Adding Media (Images, Videos, PDFs) to Projects

Three Simple Steps:

Step 1: Put your files in the right place

Drop files into: `assets/images/projects/`

Examples:

- `nutrient-screenshot.png`
- `droplet-video.mp4`
- `research-report.pdf`

Step 2: Open `data/site.json` and add media section

Find your project, add this after the "image" line:

```
"media": [  
  {  
    "type": "image",  
    "url": "assets/images/projects/nutrient-screenshot.png",  
    "label": "Simulation result"  
  },  
  {  
    "type": "video",  
    "url": "assets/images/projects/droplet-video.mp4",  
    "label": "Animation video"  
  },  
  {  
    "type": "pdf",  
    "url": "assets/images/projects/report.pdf",  
    "label": "Research report"  
  }  
]
```

Step 3: Push your changes

```
git add -A  
git commit -m "Added media to nutrient transport project"  
git push
```

Wait 1-2 minutes, refresh your website, done! Click the project to see your media gallery.

4. Git Commands You'll Use Frequently

The Command You'll Use 99% of the Time:

```
git add -A && git commit -m "Your message" && git push
```

Type this, press Enter, wait 1-2 minutes, refresh website. Done!

Other Useful Commands (Reference):

Check status (see what changed):

```
git status
```

Shows files that changed since your last push.

See your recent changes:

```
git log --oneline
```

Lists your last commits (like a history).

Undo your last change:

```
git reset --hard HEAD~1
```

Goes back to before your last commit. Use only if you made a big mistake.

Make sure you're on the right branch:

```
git branch
```

You should see `* main`. If not, run: `git checkout main`

5. Publishing Your Changes

The Steps (Every Time You Update):

- ① **1. Make your changes:** Edit site.json, add media files, write blog posts, etc.
- ② **2. Test locally (optional):** Run `start-local-windows.bat` or `start-local-mac-linux.sh`, open `http://localhost:8000`
- ③ **3. Push to GitHub:** `git add -A && git commit -m "msg" && git push`
- ④ **4. Wait 1-2 minutes:** GitHub updates your website automatically
- ⑤ **5. Refresh your browser:** `Ctrl+Shift+R` (Windows) or `Cmd+Shift+R` (Mac)

Unpublish / Republish:

Go to GitHub repo Settings > Pages > Source > "None" to unpublish. Set back to "main" to republish.

6. Troubleshooting

"Git command not found"

Git isn't installed. Download from git-scm.com (Windows) or run `git --version` (Mac).

"Permission denied" when pushing

Your GitHub token expired. Go to GitHub > Settings > Developer settings > Personal access tokens, generate a new one.

Media doesn't show on website

Check: File path is correct, filename spelling matches, JSON is valid (check jsonlint.com), you pushed changes, browser is refreshed.

"JSON parse error"

You have a typo in `site.json`. Use jsonlint.com to find it. Common: missing comma, extra comma, missing quotes.

Website looks broken

Hard refresh: `Ctrl+Shift+R` (Windows) or `Cmd+Shift+R` (Mac). If still broken, check you didn't edit `styles.css` or `script.js` by accident.

7. Quick Reference Cheat Sheet

Task	How to do it	Git Command (if needed)
Add a new project	Edit data/site.json, add project block	git add -A && git commit -m "New project" && git push
Replace project image	Drop new image in assets/images/projects/	git add -A && git commit -m "Updated image" && git push
Add video to project	Drop .mp4 in assets/images/projects/, add to megaladray in site.json	git add -A && git commit -m "Added video" && git push
Write blog post	Create .md file in posts/, add filename to posts/posts.json	git add -A && git commit -m "New post" && git push
Update CV	Replace assets/cv/Sagar-Gharti-CV.pdf with your new PDF	git add -A && git commit -m "Updated CV" && git push
Change your bio	Edit data/site.json, change "person" section	git add -A && git commit -m "Updated bio" && git push
See what changed	Type: git status	
Undo mistake	Type: git reset --hard HEAD~1	

Need help? Check the included PROJECT-MEDIA-GUIDE.md and COMPLETE-GUIDE.md files in your portfolio.